Śhrī Bahurūpa-garbha Stotra

Oṁ śhrī Gurave Namaḥ - Śhrī Svacchanda Bhairavāya

tripañca-nayanaṁ devaṁ jaṭā-mukuṭa-maṇḍitam |
candrakoṭi-pratīkāśhaṁ candrārdha-kṛita-śhekharam || 1
pañca-vaktraṁ viśhālākṣhaṁ sarpa-gonāsa-maṇḍitam |
vṛiśhcikair-agni-varṇā-bhair - hāreṇa tu virājitam || 2

Svacchanda Bhairava has fifteen eyes in total, with three eyes on each of his five faces. His head is adorned with a crown of matted hair. His body radiates like millions of moons. His forehead is beautifully adorned with a crescent moon. His five faces have large eyes. His neck is adorned with snakes (*gonāsa*). Not only this, his neck is also decorated with a garland of firery-red scorpions.

kapāla-mālā-bharaṇaṁ khaḍga-kheṭaka-dhāriṇam |
pāśh-āṅkuśha-dharaṁ devaṁ śhara-hastaṁ pināka̱m || 3

His wears a garland of human skulls, and holds a sword and shield in two hands. A noose (of Yama) and an aṅkuśha (used to control elephants) are in two other hands. In addition, he also holds an arrow and a bow named "Pināka" [the bow of Śiva].

varad-ābhaya-hastaṁ cha muṇḍa-khaṭvāṅga-dhāriṇam |
viṇā-ḍamaru-hastaṁ cha ghaṇṭā-hastaṁ triśhūlinam || 4

Two hands are beautifully positioned in the gestures of blessing (*varada*) and fearlessness (*abhaya*). He also holds a skull (muṇḍa) and *khaṭvāṅga* (a skull-topped club). In addition to these, in four other hands, he holds a lute (*viṇā*), a drum (*ḍamaru*), a bell (*ghaṇṭa*), and a trident (*triśūla*).

vajra-daṇḍa-kṛitāṭopaṁ paraśhvāyudha-hastakam |
mudgareṇa vicitreṇa vartulena virājitam || 5

In His four other hands, he holds a thunderbolt (vajra), the staff (daṇḍa) [of Yama], an axe (*paraśu*), and a round mace (*mudga*) decorated with various colors.

siṁha-carma-parīdhānaṁ gaja-carmottarī-yakam |
aṣhṭā-daśha-bhujaṁ devaṁ nīlakaṇṭhaṁ sutejasam || 6

Wearing a lion skin garment about his loins, an elephant’s hide for his upper garment, having eighteen arms, he is called God of gods, being blue throated and radiant because he is filled with consciousness.

ūrdhva-vaktraṁ maheśhāni sphaṭikābhaṁ vicintayet |
āpītaṁ pūrva-vaktraṁ tu nīlot-paladala-prabham || 7
dakṣhiṇaṁ tu vijānīyād - vāmaṁ caiva vicintayet |
dāḍimī-kusuma-prakhyaṁ kuṅkumodaka-saṁnibham || 8
candrārbuda-pratīkāśhaṁ paśhcimaṁ tu vicintayet |

Svacchandanātha's upper face is the color of crystal, and, like the filaments of the lotus, His eastern face is yellow; his southern face is blue like the colour of a lotus flower. The northern face is like the pomegranate flower and the colour of Kumkum; His western face shines like the a billion eternal moons, and He wears the crescent moon on his forehead.

svacchanda-bhairavaṁ devaṁ sarva-kāma-phalapradam || 9
dhyāyedvai yastu yuktātmā kṣhipraṁ siddhyati mānavaḥ |

One should meditate on Svacchanda Bhairava as described above, as He is the bestower of all desired fruits, and hence, is capable of fulfilling all desires.

yā sā pūrvaṁ mayā khyātā aghorī śhaktir-uttamā || 10
bhairavaṁ pūjayitvā tu tasyot-saṅge-gatāṁ nyaset |
yādṛiśhaṁ bhairavaṁ rūpaṁ bhairavyāstād-ṛigeva hi || 11
īṣhat-karāla-vadanāṁ gambhira-vipulasvanām |
prasan-nāsyāṁ sadā-dhyāyed - bhairavīṁ vismite-kṣhaṇām || 12

The sincere aspirant who meditates on Svacchandanātha in this way will certainly attain their desired goals. And, after meditating on Bhairava, one should place the supreme Aghorī Śakti (Bhairavī) in Bhairava's lap. Her form is described the same way as Bhairava's, only Her face is slightly terrifying because she occasionally transforms into the form of Kālī Devi. Her voice is also deep, and her eyes are filled with wonder. In this way Bhairava and Bhairavī should be meditated upon with one-pointed devotion.

[See Appendix for Kṣemarāja's commentary on the above verses from the Svacchanda Tantra, Chapter 2, verses 88b-94a; 94-97; 114-116.]

Śhrī Bahurūpa-garbha Stotraḥ

brahmādi-kāraṇā-tītaṁ sva-śhakty-ānanda-nirbharam |
namāmi parameśhānaṁ svacchandaṁ viraṇāyakam || 1

I bow to the Supreme Śiva, who is beyond the causes such as Brahmā etc., who is filled with bliss along with his own power, who is the Supreme Lord, Svacchanda, the lord of heroes, Lord Aghora Nātha. ||1||

kailāsa-śhikharā-sīnaṁ deva-devaṁ jagad-gurum |
papraccha praṇatā devī bhairavaṁ vigatāmayaṁ || 2

Once Goddess Bhairavī approached the God of gods –Svacchanda Bhairava – who was seated on the peak of Mount Kailash. With bowed head and foled hands the Supreme Goddess asked the following question. ||2||

Śhrī Devī Uvāca

prāyaśhcitteṣhu sarveṣhu samayol-laṅghaneṣhu cha |
mahābhayeṣhu ghoreṣhu tīvropa-drava-bhūmiṣhu || 3
chidra-sthāneṣhu sarveṣhu sadupāyaṁ vada prabho! |
yenā 'yāsena-rahito nirdoṣhaśh cha bhaven-naraḥ || 4

O Lord! For the sake of those people who knowingly or unknowlingly violate the rules and regulations of *śāstras*, and who, despite sincere efforts to attone for their past transgressions, become terrified by the fear arising from their past actions, who live in a state of severe calamity, and who are tainted by all misfortunes – O Lord! please tell us the remedy by which they may be easily liberated from the effects of those actions. 3-4

Śhrī Bhairava Uvāca

śhṛiṇu devī! paraṁ guhyaṁ rahasyaṁ paramād-bhutam |
sarva-pāpa-praśhamanaṁ sarva-duḥkha-nivāraṇam || 5
prāyaśhcitteṣhu sarveṣhu tīvreṣhva 'pi vimocanam |
sarva-cchidrāpa-haraṇaṁ sarvārti-vini-vārakam || 6
samayol-laṅghane ghore japādeva vimocanam |
bhoga-mokṣha-pradaṁ devī! sarva-siddhi-phalapradam || 7

Śrī Bhairava said:

"O Devī! Listen carefully to this supremely secret and most wonderful mystery, which pacifies all sins, removes all sorrows, purifies all atonements whether intense or mild, removes all flaws, prevents all afflictions, liberates one even from the transgression of the all the rules. O Devī! The mere recitation of this hymn grants both enjoyment (*bhoga*) and liberation (*mokṣa*), and brings the about fruits of all accomplishments." || 5-6-7||

śhatajāpyena śhuddhyanti mahā-pāta-kino 'pi ye |
tada'rdhaṁ pātakaṁ hanti tat-pādenopapātakam || 8

By reciting this [Śrī Bahurūpa-Garbha-Stotra] a hundred times, even those who have committed great sins become purified. Reciting it fifty times destroys sins committed inadvertently through mistakes; reciting it twenty-five times destroys all minor sins. ||8||

kāyikaṁ vācikaṁ caiva mānasaṁ sparśha-doṣhajam |
pramādād-icchayā vā 'pi sakṛit-jāpyena śhuddhyati || 9

If one has caused pain to someone through body, speech, or mind; or touched someone inappropriately, whether through inattention or knowingly - the removal of this sin happens with just one recitation of this stotra, or japa of the Aghora mantra. ||9||

yāgārambhe cha yāgānte paṭhitavyaṁ prayat-nataḥ |
nitye naimit-tike kāmye parasy-āpyā-'tmano 'pi vā || 10

This Hymn should be recited at the beginning and end of a *yajnas* with great faith and effort. It should also be recited in daily rituals and ceremonies like *śrāddha*, as it removes the flaws and faults that occure due to ignorance or deficiencies during those rituals. It should be recited for one's own benefit or for the welfare of others.

niśhchidra-karaṇaṁ proktaṁ svabhāva-paripūrakam |
dravyahīne mantrahīne yajña-yoga-vivarjite || 11
bhakti-śhraddhā-virahite śhuddhi-śhūnye viśheṣhataḥ |
mano-vikṣhepa-doṣhe cha vilope paśhu-vīkṣhite || 12
vidhihīne pramāde ca - japtavyaṁ sarva-karmasu |
nātaḥ parataro mantro nātaḥ paratarā stutiḥ || 13

The recitation or reading of this Hymn helps in successfully completing every auspicious work without obstacles. It fulfills virtuous conduct. Not only this, but even a person without wealth, unfamiliar with mantras, not knowing the practice of *yajnas* and *yoga*, without devotion to the Lord, without faith, impure, covered with sins causing mental distress, and corrupted by being misled by the wicked - if they recite this, their inner-self becomes purified. There is no mantra greater than this *stotra*, no hymn superior to it,

nātaḥ paratarā kācit - samyak-pratyaṅgirā priye |
iyaṁ samaya-vidyānāṁ rāja-rājeśhvarīśhvari! || 14

O beloved Devi! There is no counteracting formula, that neutralizes ritual mistakes, more perfect than this. This is the queen of all the knowledge of precepts, O Ishvari! || 14||

paramā 'pyāyanaṁ devi! bhairavasya prakīrtitam |
prīṇanaṁ sarva-devānāṁ sarva-saubhāgya-vardhanam || 15
stavarāja-mimaṁ puṅyaṁ śhṛiṇvaṣhvā 'vahitā priye |

O Goddess! This Stotra, filled with the glorification of Para Bhairava, is completely satisfying and pleasing to all the gods. It bestows all good fortune and increases well-being. ||15||

Listen with full attention – O Dear One! – to this auspicious King of Hymns

asya śhrī bahurūpa bhaṭṭāraka stotrasya
śhrī vāmadeva ṛiṣhiḥ anuṣhṭup-chandaḥ
śhrī bahurūpa bhaṭṭārako devatā ātmano
vāṅ-manaḥ kāyopār-jita-pāpa-nivāraṇ-ārthaṁ
catur-varga siddhyarthe pāṭhe viniyogaḥ ||

The Ṛiṣi of this highly revered Bahurupabhaṭṭāraka Stotra is Vāmadeva, the meter is Anuṣṭupa, Shri Bahurūpabhaṭṭāraka (i.e., Svacchanda Bhairava – Aghoranātha) is the Devatā, and the purpose of the recitation lies in removing the sins committed by way of speech, mind and body and attending the fourfold goals of life [*dharma, artha, kāma* and *mokṣa*].

[meditation on Svacchanda Nātha]

vāme kheṭaka-pāśha-śharṅga-vila sat-
daṇḍaṁ cha vīṇāṇṭike
vibhrāṇam dhvaja-mudgarau svanibhade
vyaṅkaṁ kuṭhāraṁ kare |
dakṣhe sya'ṅkuśha-kandaleṣhu-ḍamarūn-
vājara-triśhūlā-bhayān-
rūdrasthaṁ śhara-vaktram-indu-dhavalaṁ
svacchanda-nāthaṁ stumaḥ ||

[atha gāyatrī]
[The following translation taken from Swamiji's
letter to John Hughes, 13th June 1989.]

His eighteen arms represent: his divine five breaths: (1) *prāṇa*, (2) *apāna*, (3) *samāna*, (4) *udāna* and (5) *vyāna*.; his 5 acts: (6) creating, (7) protecting, (8) destroying, (9) concealing and (10) revealing; his five internal divine acts: (11) *abhāsanā*, (12) *rakti*, (13) *vimarśanā*, (14) *bījava-sthāpanā* and (15) *tat vilāpanā*, and also: (16) divine mind, (17) divine intellect and (18) divine *ahaṁkāra*-ego.

Now meaning of his weapons:

Vame: by the nine divine left hands of Svacchandanātha He holds:
Khetaka: (1) shield.
Pāśa (2) noose used as a weapon
Śārṅga vilasat (3) a bow
Daṇḍaṁ ca (4) a stick to give punishment to sinners
vīṇā aṇdike (5) a lute for singing His own glory
bibrāṇaṁ dvaja: holding (6) flag of victory
mudgarau: and (7) hammer
svanibha devaṇkaṁ (8) another weapon of His Śakti
kuṭhāraṁ: and holding in His hand (9) a hatchet or axe

By the right side of His nine arms He holds:

Asi: (1) a sword
Aṇkuśa: (2) a hook for catching
Kandala: (3) a Kandala flower
Eṣu: (4) an arrow
Damarūn: (5) a small drum
Vajra: (6) a thunderbolt
Triśūlā: (7) a Triśūla 3-spokeswalla weapon.
Abhayān: bestowing with right hand (8) boons to His devotees
(Understood): The weapon of His divine Śakti will be (9)
Rudrastham̀: This way riding of the shoulders of Rudra, Svacchanda Bhairava having five heads, we prostrate before Svacchandanātha with devotion, love and honor"

Oṁ bahurupāya vidmahe, koṭarākṣhāya dhīmahi
tanno ‘ghoraḥ pracodayāt [*3 times*]

We meditate on Aghoranātha who we know (*vidmahe*) has taken the formation of all things (*bahurūpāya*), and whose senses are all-pervading (whose perceives everything everywhere-*koṭarākṣāya*). May He (in the form of Svacchanda Bhairava) uplift us!

[Mūla Mantra]

aghorebhyo ‘tha ghorebhyo ghoraghoratarī-bhyaśh-cha |
sarvatah śharva! sarvebhyo namaste rudrarūpebhyaḥ [10 times]

O Lord Śiva! You alone transform yourself into all forms, into the forms of the powers of Rudra as Āghorā, the enlightening and uplifting energy, Ghoratarī, the frightful darkening energy which pushes one down, and Ghorā, the energy which keeps one fixed, neither rising or falling. These forms, embodied in Rudra Śiva, are helpful to the aspirant while they are aware, and frightful for the one’s who is ignorant, pushing them down and down.

Śhrī Bhairavaḥ

OṀ namaḥ param-ākāśha - śhāyine param-ātmane |
śhivāya para-saṁśhānta - nirānanda-padāya te || 1

AGHOREBHYO

avācya-yā-prameyāya pramātre viśhva-hetave |
mahā-sāmānya-rūpāya sattām-ātraika-rūpiṇe || 2
ghoṣhādi-daśhadhā-śhabda - bīja-bhutāya śhambhave |
namaḥ śhāntogra-ghorādi - mantra-sandarbha-garbhiṇe || 3
revatī-saṅga-visrambha - samāśhleṣha-vilāsine |
namaḥ samarasāsvāda - parānando-pabhogine || 4
bhogapaṇe namastubhyaṁ yogīśhaiḥ pūjit-ātmane |
dvayanir-dalanodyoga - samullāsita-mūrtaye || 5

SA in place of THA

sarat-prasara-vikṣhobha - visṛiṣhṭ-ākhila-jantave |
namo māyā-svarūpāya sthāṇave parameṣhṭhine || 6

GHOREBHYO

ghora-saṁsāra-saṁbhoga - dāyine sthiti-kāriṇe |
kalā-dikṣhiti-paryanta - pāline vibhave namaḥ || 7
rehaṇāya mahāmoha dhvānta-vidhvaṁ-sahetave |
hṛidayāmbhoja-saṁkoca - bhedine śhiva-bhānave || 8
bhoga-mokṣha-phala-prāptir - hetuyoga-vidhāyine |
namaḥ parama-nirvāṇa - dāyine candramaulaye || 9

GHORA

ghoṣhyāya sarva-mantrāṇāṁ sarvavāṅ-maya-mūrtaye |
namaḥ sarvāya śharvāya sarva-pāśhāpa-hāriṇe || 10
ravaṇāya ravāntāya namaste rāvarāviṇe |
nityāya supra-buddhāya sarvāntara-tamāya te || 11

GHORATARĪBHYAŚ CA

ghoṣhāya paranādānta - śhcarāya khacarāya te |
namo vākpataye tubhyaṁ bhavāya bhava-bhedine || 12
ramaṇāya ratīśhāṅga - dāhine citra-karmiṇe |
namaḥ-śhaila-sutā-bhartre viśhva-kartre mahātmane || 13
tamaḥ pāra-pratiṣhṭhāya sarvānta-padagāya te |
namaḥ samasta-tattvādhva - vyāpine cit-svarūpiṇe || 14
revad-varāya rudrāya namaste rūpa-rūpiṇe |
parāpara pari-spanda - mandirāya namo namaḥ || 15
bharit-ākhila-viśhvāya yogagamyāya yogine |
namaḥ sarve-śhvareśhāya mahā-haṁsāya śhambhave || 16
carcyāya carcanīyāya carcakāya carāya te |
ravīndu-sandhi-saṁsthāya mahā-cakreśha te namaḥ || 17

SARVĀTA

sarvā-nusyūta-rūpāya sarvā-cchādaka-śhaktaye |
sarva-bhakṣhāya śharvāya namaste sarva-vedine || 18
ramyāya valla-bhāktrānta - dehārdhāya viyogine |
namaḥ prapanna-duṣhprāpya - saubhāgya-phala-dāyine || 19
tanmaheśhāya tattvārtha - vedine bhava-vedine |
mahā-bhairava-nāthāya bhakti-gamyāya te namaḥ || 20

ŚHARVA-SARVEBHYO

śhakti-garbha-pravodhāya śharaṇyāyā ‘śharīriṇe |
śhānti-puṣhṭyādi-sādhyārtha - sādhakāya namo ‘stu te || 21

ravat-kuṇḍalinī-garbha - prabodha-prāpta-śhaktaye |
utsphoṭa-nāpaṭu-prauḍha - param-ākṣhara-mūrtaye || 22
samasta-vyasta-saṁgrasta - raśhmi-jālodar-ātmane |
namastubhyaṁ mahāmina - rūpiṇe viśhva-garbhiṇe || 23
revāraṇi-samudbhūta - vahni-jvālāvabhāsine |
ghanī-bhūta-vikalpātma - viśhva-bandha-vilāpine || 24
bhoginī-syandanā-rūḍhi - prauḍhi-mālabdha-garviṇe |
namaste sarva-bhakṣhyāya param-āmṛita-lābhine || 25

NAMASTE

naphakoṭi-samāveśha - bharit-ākhila-sṛiṣhṭaye |
namaḥ śhakti-śharīrāya koṭi-dvitaya-saṅgine || 26
mahā-moha-malā-krānta - jīva-vargava-bodhine |
maheśhvarāya jagatāṁ namaḥ kāraṇa-bandhave || 27
stenonmūlana-dakṣhaika - smṛitaye viśhva-mūrtaye |
namaste ‘stu mahādeva - nāmne para-svadhātmane || 28

RUDRA-RUPEBHYA

rugdrāviṇe mahā-vīrya - ruru-vaṁśha-vināśhine |
rudrāya drāvitā-śheṣha - bandhanāya namo ‘stu te || 29
dravat-para-rasāsvāda - carvaṇodyukta-śhaktaye |
namastri-daśha-pūjyāya sarva-kāraṇa-hetave || 30
rupātīta namastubhyaṁ namaste bahurūpiṇe |
tryambakāya tridhāmānta - śhcariṇe cha tri-cakṣhuṣhe || 31
peśhalopāya-labhyāya bhakti-bhājāṁ mahātmanām |
durlabhāya malā-krānta - cetasām tu namo-namaḥ || 32
bhava-pradāya duṣhṭanāṁ bhavāya bhava-bhedine |
bhavyānāṁ tan-mayānāṁ tu sarvadāya namo-namaḥ || 33

aṇūnāṁ muktaye ghora - ghora-saṁsāradāyine |
ghorāti-ghora-mūṭhānāṁ tiraskartre namo-namaḥ || 34

[Verse to Parā Śhakti]

sarva-kāraṇakalā-pakalpitol-
lāsasaṁ-kula-samādhi-viṣhṭharām |
hārdako-kanadasaṁ-sthitāmapi
tāṁ praṇaumi śhivaval-labhām-ajām ||
sarva-jantu-hṛidayāb-ja-maṇḍalod-
bhūta-bhāva-madhupāna-lumpaṭām |
varṇa-bheda-vibhavānta-rasthitāṁ
tāṁ praṇaumi śhiva-val-labhām-ajām ||

[Fruit of this recitation]

ityevaṁ stotra-rājeśhaṁ mahābhairava-bhāṣhitam |
yoginīnāṁ paraṁ sāraṁ na dadyād-yasya kasyacit || 1 ||

Thus, this king of hymns spoken by great Bhairava Nātha, which is the supreme essence for the Yoginīs, should not be given to just anyone.

adīkṣhite śhaṭhe krūre niḥsatye śhuci-varjite |
nāstike cha khale mūrkhe pramatte viplute 'lase || 2 ||
guru-śhāstra-sadācāra - dūṣhake kalaha-priye |
nindake cumbhake kṣhudre - 'samayajñe cha dāṁbhike || 3 ||
dākṣhiṇya-rahite pāpe dharmahīne cha garvite
bhakti-yukte pradāt-avyaṁ na deyaṁ para-dīkṣhite || 4 ||
paśhūnāṁ sannidhau devi! noccāryaṁ sarvathā-kvacit |
asya smṛiti-mātreṇa vighnā naśhyantya-nekaśhaḥ || 5 ||
guhya-kā yātu-dhānāśh cha vetālā rākṣha-sādayaḥ |
ḍākinyaśh cha piśhā-cāśh cha krūra-sattvāśh cha pūtanāḥ || 6 ||
naśhyanti sarve paṭhita - stotra-syāsya prabhā-vataḥ |
khecarī bhūcarī caiva ḍākinī śhākinī tathā || 7 ||
ye cānye bahudhā bhūtā duṣhṭa-sattvā bhayānakāḥ |
vyādhidaur-bhikṣhadaur-bhāgya - mārimoha-viṣhādayaḥ || 8 ||
gaja-vyāghrāda-yobhītā palāyante diśho daśha |
sarve duṣhṭāḥ praṇa-śhyanti cet-yājñā pārameśhvarī || 9 ||

Iti śhrī Lalita Svacchande Bahurūpa Garbha Stotra-rājaḥ Saṁpūrṇaḥ

Not to the uninitiated, the deceitful, the cruel, the untruthful, the impure; nor to the atheist, the wicked, the foolish, the careless, and those deprived of vigor.
Not to those who defame guru, scripture, and good conduct, who love quarrels, who criticise, to the lazy, to the mean, to those who break their vows, and to the hypocrites. Not to those devoid of compassion, to sinners, to those without *dharma*, and to avarice.
It should be given to those endowed with devotion, but not to those initiated elsewhere.
O Goddess! It should never be recited in the presence of the uninitiated.
By the mere remembrance of this, obstacles are destroyed completely.
Guhyakas, demons, vetālas, rākṣasas and others, ḍākinīs and piśācas, cruel beings and pūtanās, all are destroyed by the power of reciting this hymn.
Khecarī, bhūcarī, ḍākinī, śākinī as well, and whatever other malevolent fearsome beings exist in many forms, in short, all disease, famine, misfortune, epidemics, delusion, poison, etc., are destroyed.
Dangerous elephants, tigers, etc., flee in the ten directions, and all evil ones are destroyed - such is the supreme order of this auspicious Hymn.

Thus the Śrī Bahurūpagarbha-stotra is complete.

APPENDIX

[The following is from the “Shri Bahurupa Garbha Stotram” commentary
by Śrīmad-Anantaśakti, Translated by Dr. Rudradeva Tripāṭhī.]

Special meaning of the above verses describing the form of Lord Svacchanda Bhairava:

There is no other such deity in this world. He has eighteen arms because of the abundance of his power, as Goddess Śārikā Devī also has eighteen arms. In this deity, whose form is described with various gestures, the pervasiveness of Bhairava-consciousness is unbroken.

For example: Since Svacchanda Nātha has five faces and each face has three eyes, so, he has fifteen eyes. Also, these eyes primarily represent the three activities of creation, maintenance, and destruction multiplied by the five powers of consciousness, bliss, will, knowledge, and action, thus making fifteen eyes. Another meaning given is that he perceives the five (principles) pervading from the gross to the subtle to the supreme through the three powers of parā, parāparā and aparā - thus he is *tripañcanāyana* (having three times five eyes).

Regarding his matted hair, it is explained that the matted locks represent the powers like *vāmā*, *aiśvaryā*, etc., situated in the higher state, and his crown represents the expansion of independence. His radiance like "millions of moons" signifies his being full of light and bliss. In this regard, the Lakṣmīkaulārṇava states: "O Goddess of gods, he is sung as Bhairava on earth because of non-duality, not because of having terrifying fangs; therefore, one should contemplate him as gentle."

His five faces represent consciousness (*cit*), bliss (*ānanda*), will (*icchā*), knowledge (*jñāna*), and action (*kriyā*), which reveal his supreme nature and take the form of protection from *saṃsāra* (the wheel of repeated births and deaths). His "large eyes" refer to the state described in the scriptures as "inwardly focused, outwardly seeing, without blinking."

The commentator [Kṣemarāja] has explained the special meanings of the form and weapons described above, such as:

1-Sword: Through the power of knowledge, it cuts the bonds.

2-Shield: Through the power of action, it removes the fears of devotees in saṃsāra.

3-Noose: The binding of the universe and independence.

4-Goad: The attraction of that.

5-6-Arrow and bow (*śara* and *pināka*): Breaking the garland of causal knots.

7-8-Boon-giving and fearlessness gestures: Bestowing enjoyment and liberation.

9-Skull: Removing the skull of māyā which is ignorance.

10-Skull-topped staff (*khaṭvāṅga*): The attachment of the universe, which is like bones and skeleton without support, to one's wall of consciousness.

11-12-13-*Vīṇā*, drum, and bell: The power that is attentive, observant, and alert to the *nāda* that is the basis of the variety of deep, high, and middle sounds.

14-Trident: With the staff of the power of independence that is united with desire, knowledge, and action, the trident destroys the three bonds.

15-Thunderbolt: Through the triad of powers like desire situated above and the triad of desires, etc., situated below, having the power of the nature of the entire universe.

16-Staff: Through the power of necessity, controlling the universe.

17-Axe: Having the form of a plow, the nature of the power of sound.

18-Mace: In the form of the bindu power, crushing the entire manifold of differences.

Similarly, the lion is explained as the expansion of consciousness that is the five-faced one consisting of Vidyeśvara, Sadāśiva, Śakti, and Śiva; its "skin" is its behavior. And the elephant, being very expansive and of the nature of *māyā*, its upper garment worn above the non-dual nature of consciousness is his own form.

The deity is playful in nature. His blue neck removes the great poison of ignorance in the form of non-recognition. His brilliance is dense with consciousness and bliss. The variety of his faces in different directions indicates the variety of his activities of grace, etc. With a focused mind, one attains enjoyment (*bhoga*) and liberation (*mokṣa*). The fruit of [Svacchanda Bhairava's] visualization alone is said to give all accomplishments - this is declared as his great power. This is also the fruit obtained from recitation with concentration, which is the great efficacy of this stotra.

His terrifying aspect is imitation of Bhairava through devouring bonds. His deep, expansive sound is due to the predominance of reflection. His pleased countenance is due to his inclination toward grace in accordance with the supreme Bhairava. Therefore, because of entering the mudrā of Bhairava, his "eyes show wonder."

Other epithets of Lord Bhairava: Sutejasam means full of consciousness-bliss. The faces in different directions and the upper part are symbols of the various acts of grace, etc. in those directions. One with a focused mind attains enjoyment and liberation. This is also the fruit obtained from recitation with concentration, which is the great efficacy of this stotra.

Regarding the epithets of Bhairavī, they have similar meanings: terrifying aspect - imitation of Bhairava due to devouring bonds; deep, expansive sound - predominance of reflection; pleased countenance - inclination toward grace in accordance with the supreme Bhairava. Therefore, the description of her having "wondering eyes" is also due to her entering the mudrā of Bhairava.

[END]

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